Introduced species – Rabbits

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the passage below.

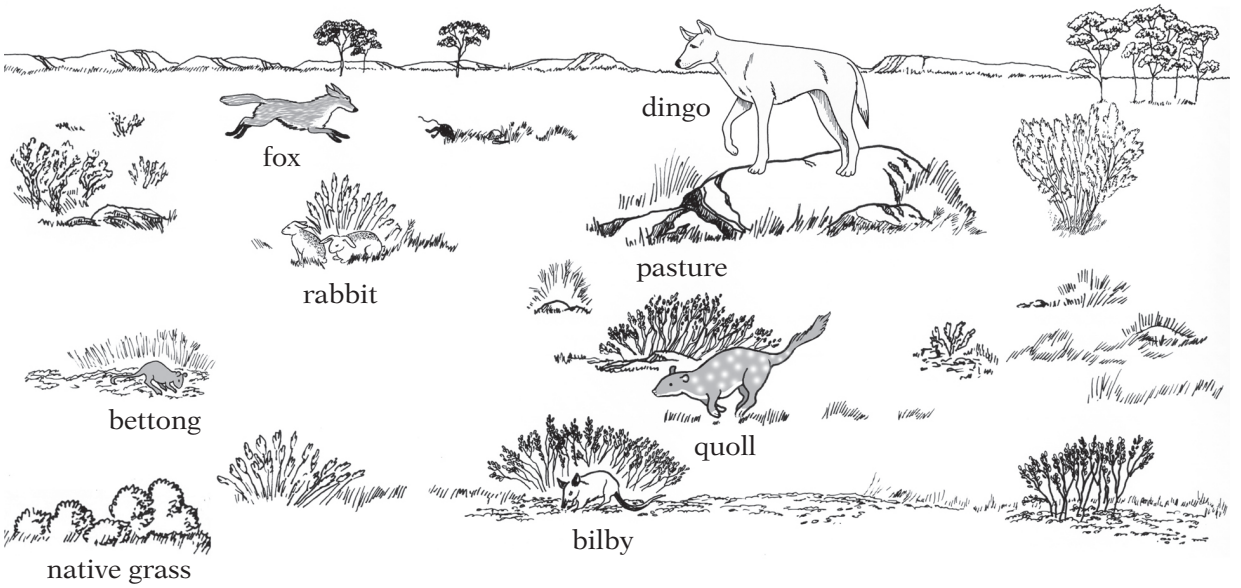
Word bank

numbers ships sea species female quoll bettong transport quickly
wild burrowed compete widespread rabbits ate animals recover

European settlers brought rabbits to Australia in their s_____. They bred q_____, were easy to t_____ and provided meat for the long months at s_____. Over the next hundred years r_____ were released into the w_____ in Australia. Their n_____ swelled because **predators** like the q_____, the dingo and introduced foxes were not w_____ or abundant.

Rabbits a_____ the new pastures that farmers grew. They also ate native grasses and b_____ into the soil. There is even evidence that f_____ rabbits have taken over the burrows of native a_____. Rabbits c_____ with native burrowing animals such as the b_____ and the bilby for food. In times of drought, numbers of all these s_____ drop, but when times are good, rabbit numbers r_____ more quickly than marsupials.

2 Draw arrows and produce a food web to show the relationships between the animals and plants in the picture.



3 List in point form the factors that make the rabbit a successful coloniser.

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

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